THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

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CLASS VIII — ENGLISH · MID-TERM PRACTICE PAPER

Session 2026–27 · Set 05

Class: VIII | Subject: English | Time: 2½ Hours | Max. Marks: 60

General Instructions:

1. The Question Paper is divided into FOUR sections. Section A: Reading 14 marks; Section B: Grammar 14 marks; Section C: Writing 12 marks; Section D: Literature 20 marks.
2. Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.
3. Marks are indicated against each question.
4. Read the questions carefully before answering.

SECTION A — READING (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**

Millets: The Forgotten Grains

Before wheat and rice became common in Indian kitchens, our ancestors ate millets like bajra, jowar and ragi. These small grains grow easily in dry regions with very little water, and they are rich in fibre, iron and calcium. In Rajasthan, bajra rotis with ghee are still a winter favourite.

In recent years doctors and farmers have rediscovered millets. They help control weight and blood sugar, and they need far fewer chemicals than other crops. The United Nations declared 2023 the International Year of Millets, encouraging the world to value these humble grains again.

1. Which of the following is a millet? **1**

(a) Wheat (b) Rice
(c) Bajra (d) Maize oil

2. Why do millets grow well in dry regions? **1**

(a) They need very little water (b) They need heavy rain
(c) They need cold weather (d) They grow only in water

3. Which year was declared the International Year of Millets? **1**

(a) 2019 (b) 2021
(c) 2023 (d) 2025

4. The word 'humble' in the passage means: **1**

(a) Proud (b) Simple and ordinary
(c) Costly (d) Colourful

5. Mention two benefits of millets according to the passage. **2**

6. What is a winter favourite in Rajasthan? **1**

Q2. Study the poster carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**



Many students bring packets of chips and sugary drinks to school instead of home-cooked food. Such foods give quick energy but little nutrition and can lead to obesity and tiredness. Health experts recommend a balanced diet with grains, pulses, fruits and vegetables along with regular exercise. Small steps taken today can keep us fit for life.

1) What do chips and sugary drinks lack? **1**

(a) Salt (b) Nutrition
(c) Taste (d) Packaging

2) How many glasses of water does the poster suggest? **1**

(a) 4 (b) 6
(c) 8 (d) 10

3) Which poster rule matches the idea of exercise in the passage? **1**

(a) Drink water (b) Play outdoors for one hour
(c) Eat fruits (d) Avoid cold drinks

4) The expression 'balanced diet' means: **1**

(a) Eating only sweets
(b) A variety of nutritious food in right amounts
(c) Eating once a day
(d) Eating only vegetables

5) Why is junk food harmful? Give two reasons. **2**

6) Who recommends a balanced diet? **1**

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q3. Do as directed.

I. Attempt any 4 from the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options. **(4x1=4)**

1) He is a very honest man; you can always _____ him.

(a) rely on (b) rely at
(c) rely for (d) rely to

2) The children are looking _____ to the holidays.

(a) forward (b) back
(c) up (d) after

3) I ran _____ my old friend in the market.

(a) into (b) off

(c) away (d) down

4) The chairman _____ the meeting at 5 p.m.

(a) wound up (b) wound off

(c) wound over (d) wound out

5) She _____ her younger brother while her mother was out.

(a) looked after (b) looked at

(c) looked for (d) looked into

II. Attempt any 4 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (4x1=4)

6) Choose the plural of 'child':

(a) childs (b) children

(c) childes (d) childrens

7) Choose the plural: 'The _____ are playing in the field.'

(a) sheep (b) sheeps

(c) sheepes (d) sheepe

8) 'Furniture' is an uncountable noun.

(State True or False.)

9) Fill in the blank with the plural of 'knife'. The cook sharpened all the _____.

10) Identify the collective noun: *A flock of birds flew over the lake.*

(a) flock (b) birds

(c) lake (d) flew

III. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

11) Choose the correct adjective: There is _____ milk in the glass.

(a) a few (b) many

(c) little (d) a number

12) Fill in the blank with the right form. He drank _____ (less / fewer) water than usual.

13) 'Beautiful' is an adjective.

(State True or False.)

14) Identify the adjective: *She wore a red dress.*

(a) She (b) wore

(c) red (d) dress

IV. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (3x1=3)

15) Choose the correct preposition: The book is _____ the table.

(a) on (b) in

(c) at (d) to

16) Fill in the blank. She is good _____ mathematics. (at / in / on)

17) 'Between' is used for two persons or things.

(State True or False.)

18) Choose the correct sentence.

(a) He is senior than me. (b) He is senior to me.

(c) He is senior from me. (d) He is senior at me.

SECTION C — WRITING (12 Marks) — 12 marks

Q4. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) Your school is celebrating Sports Day on 15 February. Write a notice in about 50 words informing students about the events, date, time and venue. You are Aman/Anita, the Sports Captain.

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(B) Write a short story of 100–120 words with the title 'The Honest Boy'. Include a clear beginning, middle and end, and a moral.

Q5. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) You are Pooja/Pankaj. Write a letter to the Editor of 'The Rajasthan Times' in 100–120 words about the increasing cases of littering in public parks and suggest remedies.

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(B) Write a letter to your cousin congratulating him/her on winning a state-level debate competition. (100–120 words)

SECTION D — LITERATURE (20 Marks) — 20 marks

Q6. Read the following passage and answer any four out of the five questions that follow: **(4x1=4)**

In 'Somebody's Mother', an old woman stands at the edge of a busy street, waiting to cross. Boys and girls rush past her, laughing and shouting, none stopping to help. Finally a boy offers his arm and guides her safely across. She blesses him and the poet says that someone, somewhere, will bless his own mother for his kindness.

a) The old woman wanted to _____ the street. (cross / paint) *(cross / paint)*

b) Many children stopped to help her.
(State True or False.)

c) Who helped the old woman?
(a) A girl (b) A boy
(c) A policeman (d) A teacher

d) What does the poet hope for the boy's mother?
(a) That she will be blessed for her son's kindness
(b) That she will be rich
(c) That she will travel
(d) That she will be famous

e) What lesson does the extract give?

Q7. Read the following extract and answer any two out of the three questions that follow: **(2x2=4)**

The morning bird begins to sing,
It wakes the world with wing on wing;
The flowers open, one by one,
To welcome in the rising sun.

a) What does the morning bird do?

b) What do the flowers do?

c) Pick out a pair of rhyming words.

Q8. Answer any four out of the five questions given below. **(4x3=12)**

a) What does the story of Major Somnath Sharma teach us about duty?

b) 'Dreams come true through determination.' How is this illustrated in Kurien's life?

c) How did Tenali Ramakrishna use humour to solve problems? Give an example.

d) What contrast do you see between the old woman and the crowd in 'Somebody's Mother'?

e) Which of the lessons you have studied this year did you like best and why? Answer in 40–50 words.